

Lysander Velmoore — Half-Elf Bard (College of Lore)



Figure 1: Character portrait

Class: Bard (College of Lore, locked) **Race:** Half-Elf **Level:** 3 **Role:** Debuff / control / team force-multiplier — turns one ally's hit into a crit, turns one enemy's hit into a miss **Personality Hook:** *Never writes about victories — only defeats, rendered in a poet's hand. Your loss is his best stanza.*

Core Stats

Ability Scores (Point Buy 27, +Half-Elf +2 CHA / +1 DEX / +1 CON)

Ability	Score	Mod
STR	8	-1
DEX	14	+2
CON	14	+2
INT	12	+1
WIS	10	+0
CHA	17	+3

Combat Vitals

- **HP:** 30 (base 20 at L3 with CON 14 + **10 HP variant buffer**)
- **AC:** 14 (Studded Leather 12 + DEX 2)
- **Speed:** 30 ft
- **Initiative:** +2
- **Proficiency Bonus:** +2
- **Hit Dice:** 3d8

Saving Throws: DEX +4, CHA +5

Skill Proficiencies: Persuasion +7 (**Expertise**), Performance +7 (**Expertise**), Deception +5, Insight +2, Arcana +3, History +3, Investigation +3 (Lore gives 3 bonus skills)

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft

Languages: Common, Elvish, plus one extra (pick any)

Equipment

- **Rapier** (1d8 piercing, finesse) — primary melee
- **Shortbow** (1d6 piercing, ranged 80/320) — fallback ranged
- **20x Arrows**
- **Studded Leather Armor**
- **Lute** (spellcasting focus; also a real instrument)
- **Entertainer's Pack** (costume, belt pouch, candles, rations, waterskin, disguise kit)
- **Starting trinket:** A leather-bound notebook of half-finished elegies for people he hasn't met yet

Class & Race Features

Bard (L3)

- **Bardic Inspiration (d6):** Bonus action to grant one creature within 60 ft a **d6 Inspiration die** (CHA mod = 3 uses per short rest). Target adds it to **one attack roll, ability check, or saving throw** within 10 minutes.
- **Spellcasting (CHA):** Spell save DC **13**, spell attack +5. Slots: **4× L1, 2× L2**.
- **Song of Rest:** Short rest heal bonus — N/A in a single-match playtest, ignore.
- **Jack of All Trades:** Add +1 (½ prof) to any ability check you're **not** proficient in. Silent buff to everything.
- **Expertise (L3, 2 skills):** Persuasion & Performance.
- **Bardic College — Lore (L3):**
 - **Bonus Proficiencies:** 3 extra skills (baked in above).
 - **Cutting Words (Reaction):** When a creature within 60 ft you can see makes an **attack roll, ability check, or damage roll**, you can use a **reaction + one Bardic Inspiration die** to subtract the die from their roll. **Can't affect creatures immune to being charmed.**

Half-Elf

- **Darkvision 60 ft**
- **Fey Ancestry:** Advantage on saves vs. Charmed; can't be magically put to sleep. (**Sleep is banned by variant rules — but still useful vs. Hold Person.** Note: Hold Person is paralysis, not charm, so Fey Ancestry does NOT help there. Hold Monster would, but not in v1.)
- **Skill Versatility:** 2 extra skill proficiencies of your choice (rolled into skill list above).

Signature Tactical Moves

1. **Hold Person Nova Setup (L2 slot).** Target the biggest martial threat (Fighter, Paladin, Barbarian) — **WIS save, DC 13.** On fail → **paralyzed for up to 1 min** (concentration, target saves each turn). **Paralyzed = fail all STR & DEX saves, attacks against it have advantage, any hit within 5 ft is an automatic critical.** You just handed your Rogue a **guaranteed 4d6 Sneak Attack + auto-crit shortsword** or your Paladin an **auto-crit Divine Smite.** Biggest single-play swing in the roster.
2. **Faerie Fire + Cutting Words Combo (L1 slot + reaction).** Round 1: **Faerie Fire** on enemy cluster (20 ft cube, DEX save DC 13) → all failed targets glow and **attacks against them have advantage** for 1 min (concentration). Now your team rolls with advantage on every attack, and you still have **Cutting Words** to cancel the enemy's best turn with a reaction. Advantage for allies + disadvantage via Cutting Words for enemies = the team carries.
3. **Vicious Mockery Spam.** Out of spell slots or conserving them? **Vicious Mockery** cantrip: target WIS save DC 13, on fail **1d4 psychic damage + disadvantage on their next attack roll.** A free “debuff the Fighter's attack next turn” every round. No resource cost.

Action Economy (Quick Reference)

Slot	Options
Action	Cast a Spell (see list) · Attack (Rapier 1d8+2, +4 to hit / Shortbow 1d6+2, +4 to hit, 80/320) · Vicious Mockery cantrip · Dash · Dodge · Hide
Bonus Action	Grant Bardic Inspiration (3/short rest) · Healing Word (L1 slot, 60 ft ally heal 1d4+3)
Reaction	Cutting Words (subtract a d6 from an enemy attack/check/damage within 60 ft) · Opportunity Attack
Movement	30 ft
Concentration slot	Faerie Fire OR Hold Person OR Invisibility OR Enhance Ability (one at a time)

Spells

Spell Save DC 13 / Spell Attack +5

Cantrips (2 known):

- **Vicious Mockery** — 60 ft, WIS save, 1d4 psychic + disadvantage on next attack
- **Minor Illusion** — 30 ft, object/sound illusion (town-phase utility + combat tricks)

L1 Spells (4 known, 4 slots):

- **Healing Word** — Bonus action, 60 ft, 1d4+3 heal (the party's best clutch revive)
- **Faerie Fire** — Concentration, 20 ft cube, DEX save, advantage on attacks vs. affected for 1 min

- **Dissonant Whispers** — 60 ft, WIS save, 3d6 psychic (half on save) + enemy **uses reaction to move away** on fail (eats their reaction, breaks positioning)
- **Bane** — Concentration, 30 ft, 3 targets CHA save, -1d4 to attacks and saves for 1 min

L2 Spells (2 known, 2 slots):

- **Hold Person** — Concentration, 60 ft, WIS save, **paralyzed** humanoid for 1 min (saves each turn). Auto-crit inside 5 ft.
- **Shatter** — 60 ft, 10 ft radius, CON save, 3d8 thunder (half on save). Crowd clear if enemies cluster.

Damage Reference

- **Rapier:** 1d8 + 2 DEX = avg 6.5 (+4 to hit)
- **Shortbow:** 1d6 + 2 DEX = avg 5.5 (+4 to hit, 80/320)
- **Vicious Mockery:** 1d4 psychic = avg 2.5 + debuff
- **Dissonant Whispers:** 3d6 = avg 10.5 (eats reaction if save fails)
- **Shatter:** 3d8 = avg 13.5 (AoE, half on save)

Real damage per turn is the Bard's teammates. His DPR looks low on paper. Track the team's rolls with Bardic Inspiration / Cutting Words / Faerie Fire up — the lift is there.

Town Phase Notes

- **Persuasion +7 + Deception +5** — best shopper / intel-gatherer in the roster. Use him at Haggling and the Tavern Rumors station.
- **Jack of All Trades (+1 to non-proficient checks)** — he's at least average at everything.
- **Lute (spellcasting focus) + Performance +7** — if there's a busking / tip-jar mini-economy in the town phase, Lysander prints gold.
- Weak at raw-muscle challenges (Arm Wrestling, Training Grounds).